

Computer Science & IT

Database Management System



Relational Model & Normal Forms

Lecture No. 06



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Recap of Previous Lecture



✓ Topic

Super key

{ Calculate # Super keys }
based on given C.Ks

✓ Topic

Closure of an attribute set

$(X)^+$ = Set of all attributes which can be determined by X

✓ Topic

Candidate key identification w.r.t. given set of FDs

Topics to be Covered



✓
Topic

Candidate key identification





Topic : Candidate key (Minimal Super key)

- ➔ Let R be the relational schema, and let X be the super key of relation R .
If no proper subset of X is a super key then X is minimal super key
i.e., X is Candidate key

eg. let $(AB)^+ =$ All attributes of relation R , so (AB) is a Superkey of R

Non-Empty proper
Subsets of AB are $\left. \begin{array}{l} \{A\}, \text{ if } (A)^+ = \text{Not all attributes of } R \\ \text{and} \\ \{B\}, \text{ if } (B)^+ = \text{Not all attributes of } R \end{array} \right\} \Rightarrow$ i.e. No proper subset
of (AB) is a S.K.
Hence, (AB) will be
a Candidate Key

#Q. Assume a relation $R(A, B, C, D, E)$ that has the following functional dependencies:

$AB \rightarrow C,$

$B \rightarrow E,$

$C \rightarrow D$

Here A & B are essential attributes of the relation

Find the Candidate key of R .

The attributes of the relation which are not present in the R.H.S. Part of any FD are called "Essential attributes" of the relation

Note: Every essential attribute must be present in Every Candidate key of the relation

#Q. Assume a relation R (A, B, C, D, E) that has the following functional

dependencies:

AB → C,

B → E,

C → D

Find the Candidate key of R.

$(AB)^+ = \{A, B, C, D, E\}$ ∴ AB is a S.K.
all attributes

→ Check for C.K.

Proper Subsets of (AB) → $(A)^+ = \{A\}$ Not all attributes ∴ "A" is not a S.K.
→ $(B)^+ = \{B, E\}$ Not all attributes ∴ B is not a S.K.

None of the proper subset of (AB) is a S.K.
∴ **AB** is a Candidate Key

$(AB)^+ = \{A, B, C, E, D\}$

all attributes of Relation

∴ AB is a Super key of relation
{ we know Both A & B are Essential
∴ No need to check w.r.t.
Proper subsets of AB.

Ans

AB is a Candidate Key.

#Q. Assume a relation R (A, B, C, D, E) that has the following functional dependencies:

$AB \rightarrow \underline{C}$,

$B \rightarrow \underline{E}$,

$\underline{C} \rightarrow \underline{D}$

Find the Candidate key of R.

AB is a Candidate Key of the relation

∴ Prime attributes = {A, B}

observe that, None of the prime attribute is present in R.H.S. part of any FD of the given FD set

Hence AB will be the only Candidate Key of given Relⁿ.

#Q. Assume a relation R (A, B, C, D, E) that has the following functional dependencies:

$AB \rightarrow C$,
 $B \rightarrow E$,
 $C \rightarrow D$,
 $E \rightarrow A$

} "B" is not present in RHS. part of any FD
 ∴ "B" is an Essential attribute.

$$(B)^+ = \{ B, E, A, C, D \}$$

Find the Candidate key of R.

Prime Attribute = { B }

Not present in RHS of any FD

∴ B is the only C.K.

all attributes
 ∴ B is a Super Key.

"B" is a key with single attribute
 ∴ B is a Candidate Key

#Q. Assume a relation R (A, B, C, D, E) that has the following functional

dependencies: $\rightarrow (AB)^+ = \{A, B, C, D, E\}$ $\therefore AB$ is a Super Key
all attributes

$AB \rightarrow C,$

$B \rightarrow E,$

$C \rightarrow D$

$E \rightarrow A$

• Check for Candidate Key

Proper subsets
of AB

$(A)^+ = \{A\}$

Not all attributes $\therefore$ Not a SK

$(B)^+ = \{B, E, A, C, D\}$

All attributes $\therefore$

B is a SK

One of the proper
subset of AB is a SK

$\therefore AB$ is just a SK,
it is not a CK

Find the Candidate key of R.

B is a Super Key

$\rightarrow$ Now check if B is a C.K. or not

"B" is a Key with a single attribute

$\therefore \boxed{B}$ is a Candidate Key

Prime Attribute = $\{B\}$



Topic : Note



If there exists any non-trivial FD in the relation of the form

$$X \longrightarrow Y$$

such that Y is a prime attribute in the relation.

then,

relation will have more than one Candidate Key

{ To find those Candidate Keys we will replace Y in the Candidate key by X and we will get a new super key, and w.r.t that new super key we will try to find new Candidate key }

#Q. Assume a relation R (A, B, C, D) that has the following functional dependencies:

$AB \rightarrow \underline{CD}$,

$D \rightarrow \underline{A}$

Find all the Candidate keys of R.

$$(AB)^+ = \{ \underline{A, B, C, D} \}$$

all attributes of relation, $\therefore AB$ is a S.K.

Check for candidate key.

Proper subsets
of AB

$$(A)^+ = \{ \underline{A} \}$$

Not all attributes

$$(B)^+ = \{ \underline{B} \}$$

Not all attributes

No proper subset
of (AB) is a
Super Key

$\therefore \boxed{AB}$ is a C.K.

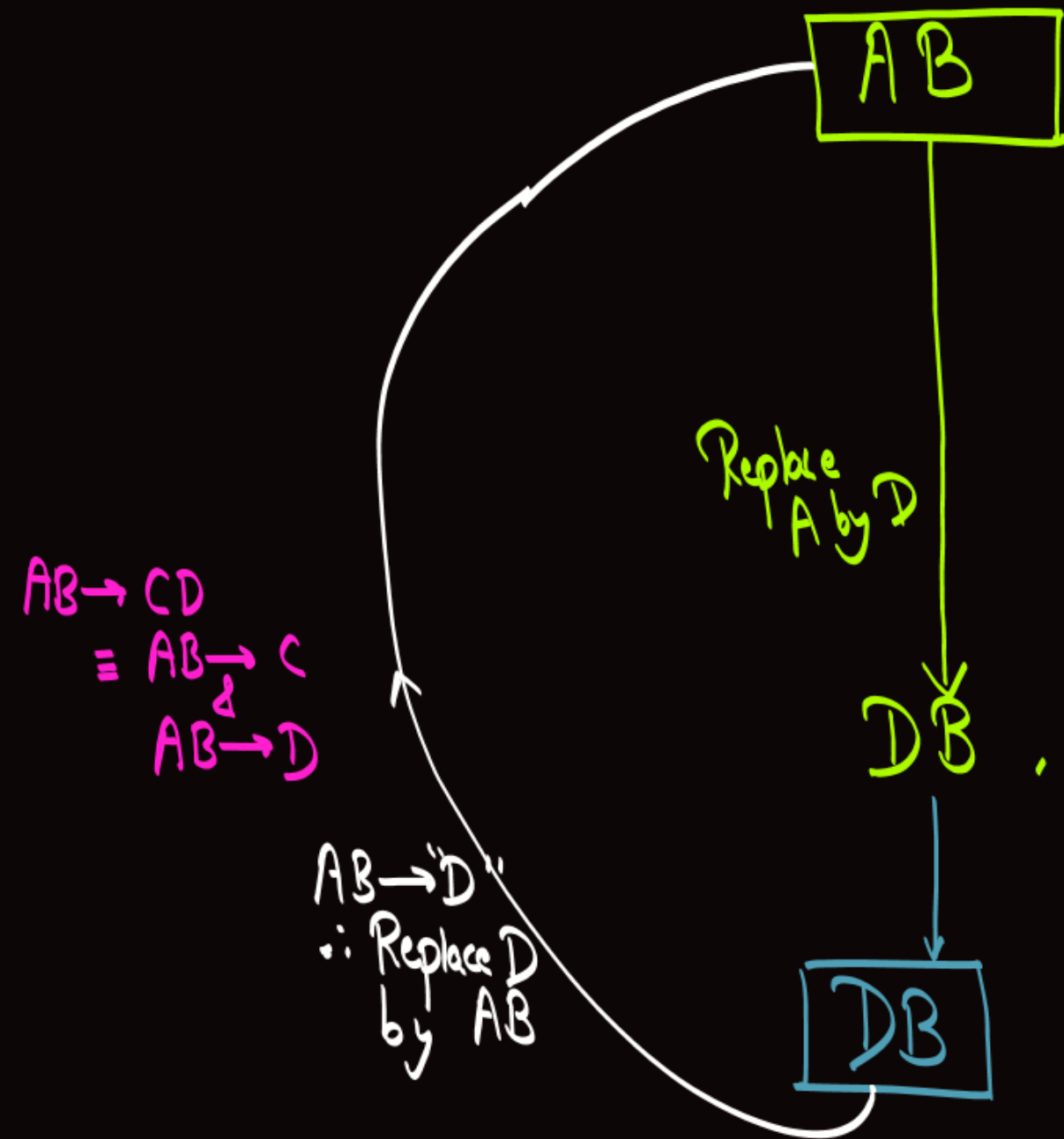
B is the Essential attribute

$$(B)^+ = \{ \underline{B} \}$$

Not all attributes

$\therefore B$ is not a S.K.,

but B will be present
in Every Candidate Key



is a Candidate Key

Prime Attributes = $\{A, B\}$

We have FD $D \rightarrow A$

s.t. 'A' is prime attribute

∴ Replace "A" by L.H.S. part of FD
i.e., Replace A by D

DB

is a Super Key

Check for C.K.

$(D)^+ = \{D, A\}$

$(B)^+ = \{B\}$

No proper subset of DB is a S.K.

is a Candidate Key

Prime Attributes = $\{A, B, D\}$

No other replacement is possible,
AB and **DB** are the only Candidate Keys of the relation.

#Q. Assume a relation R (M, N, O, P, Q) that has the following functional

dependencies:

$MNO \rightarrow PQ$ and

$P \rightarrow MN$

Find the Candidate keys of R.

"O" is the essential attribute

$$(O)^+ = \{O\}$$

Not all attributes

∴ "O" alone can not be a C.K.

$$(MNO)^+ = \{M, N, O, P, Q\}$$

all attributes ∴ (MNO) is a S.K

Check for candidate key

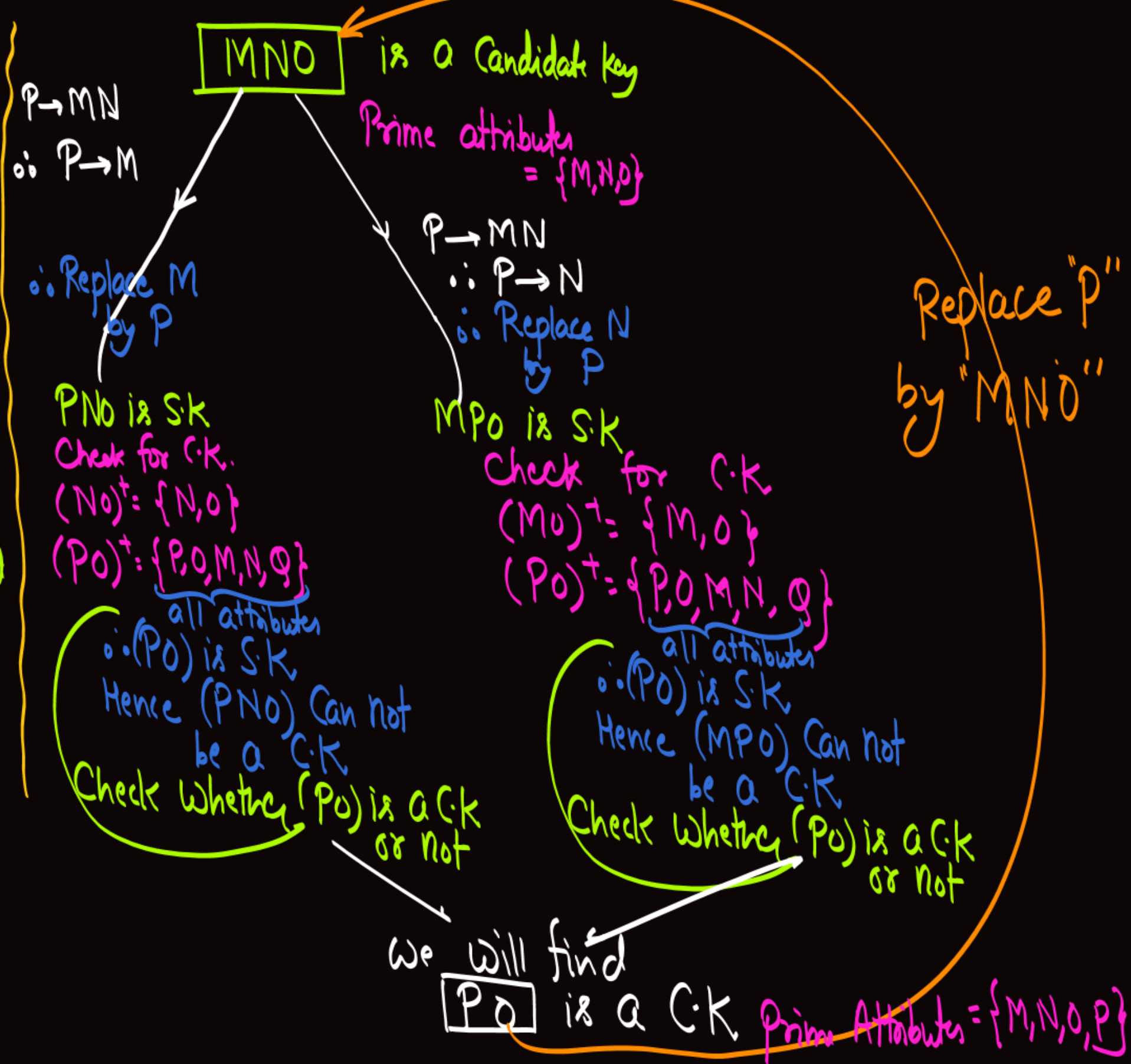
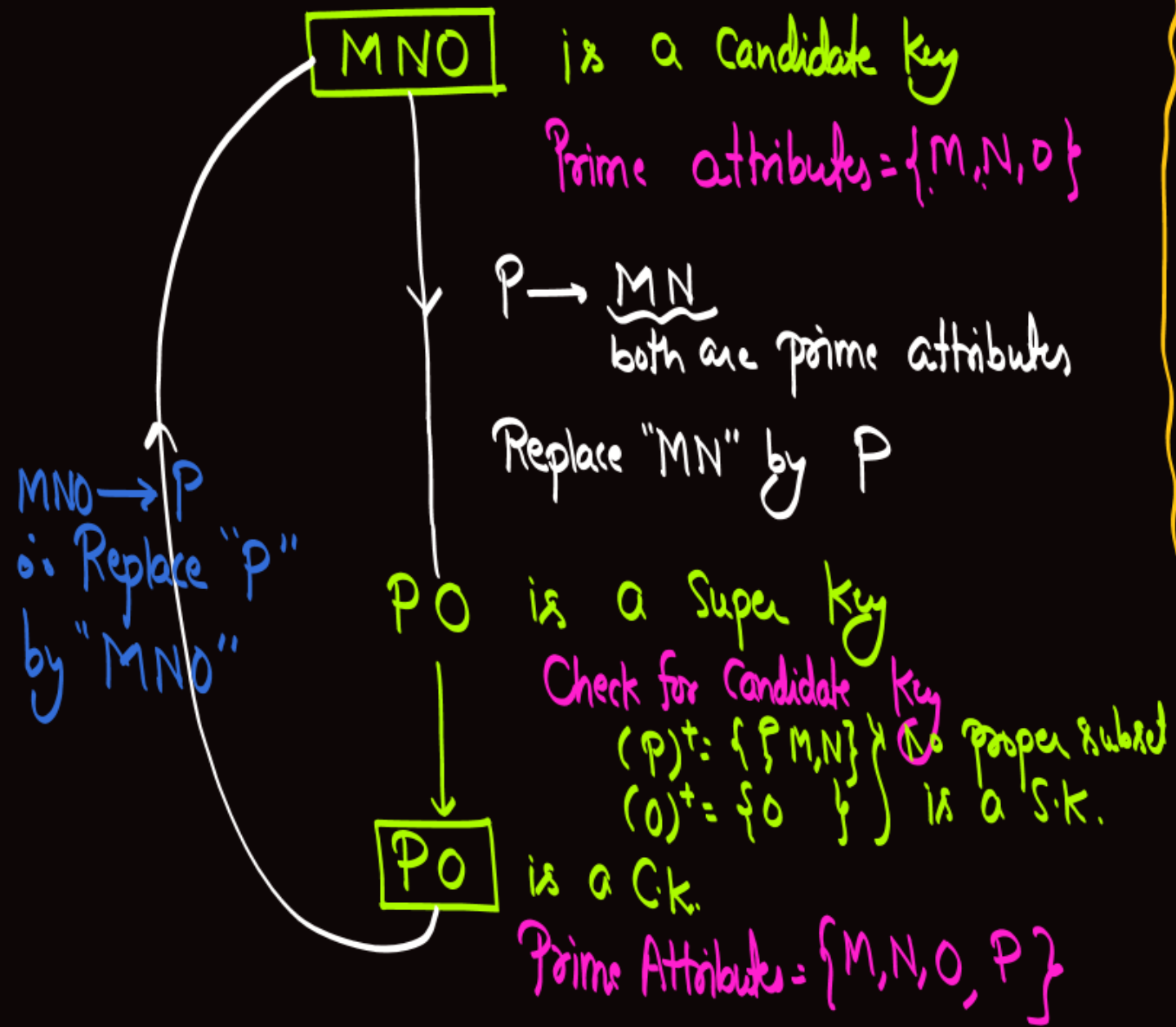
$$(MO)^+ = \{M, O\}$$

$$(NO)^+ = \{N, O\}$$

No proper subset of (MNO) is a S.K

∴ MNO

is a Candidate Key.



#Q. Assume a relation R (A, B, C, D) that has the following functional dependencies:

AB → CD

C → A

D → B

Find the Candidate keys of R.

No Essential attribute

$$(AB)^+ = \{ \underbrace{A, B, C, D}_{\text{all attributes}} \}$$

∴ AB is a Super key

Check for Candidate key

$$(A)^+ = \{A\}$$

$$(B)^+ = \{B\}$$

No Super key

∴ AB is a C.K.

AB

is a Candidate Key
Prime attributes = {A, B}

$C \rightarrow A$

∴ Replace A by C

$D \rightarrow B$

∴ Replace B by D

$C \rightarrow A$

$D \rightarrow B$

∴ Replace A by C
&
B by D

AD is S.K.

Check for C.K.

$(A)^+ = \{A\}$

$(D)^+ = \{D, B\}$

∴ **AD** is a C.K.
P.A = {A, B, D}

CB is S.K.

Check for C.K.

$(C)^+ = \{C, A\}$

$(B)^+ = \{B\}$

CB is a C.K.
Prime Attributes = {A, B, C}

CD is S.K.

Check for C.K.

$(C)^+ = \{C, A\}$

$(D)^+ = \{D, B\}$

∴ **CD** is C.K. P.A = {A, B, C, D}

$C \rightarrow A$

∴ Replace A by C

$D \rightarrow B$

∴ Replace B by D

$AB \rightarrow CD$

∴ Replace CD by AB ∴

(AB), (AD), (CB) & (CD) are the four Candidate Keys of the relation

#Q. Assume a relation $R(A, B, C, D, E, H)$ that has the following functional dependencies:

$A \rightarrow B$

$BC \rightarrow D$

$E \rightarrow C$

$D \rightarrow A$

Find the Candidate keys of R.

* E & H are the essential attributes

* $(EH)^+ = \{E, H, C\}$

E & H will be present in every C.K.
& " C " can be determined using E & H
 $\therefore$ " C " will not be required in any C.K.

$(AEH)^+ = \{A, E, H, C, B, D\}$
all attributes

$\therefore AEH$ is a Super key.
as well as

$\boxed{AEH}$ is a Candidate key.

AEH

is a Candidate Key
Prime Attributes = {A, E, H}

$D \rightarrow A$
∴ Replace A by D

DEH is a Super Key
DEH is a Candidate Key
Prime Attributes = {A, E, H, D}

$BC \rightarrow D$
∴ Replace D by BC

BCEH is a S.K. ⇒ Check for Candidate Key
↓
BEH is a new (smaller size) Super Key

BEH is a Candidate Key
Prime Attributes = {A, E, H, D, B}

$A \rightarrow B$
∴ Replace B by A

as well as

(AEH), (DEH) & (BEH) are the Candidate Keys of the relation

$(BEH)^+ = \{B, E, H, C, D, A\}$
all attributes
∴ BEH is a S.K.
Hence "BCEH" is just a Super Key, it is not a C.K.
 $(CEH)^+ = \{C, E, H\}$



2 mins Summary



Topic

Candidate key identification ✓

Slide

THANK - YOU